



Understanding Egg Freezing

For many, egg freezing is not about delaying motherhood; it is about keeping a door open

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← **F THERE IS** one meaningful shift in the journey of women over the past few decades, it is the growing ability to choose. Women today have far greater freedom to decide whether they want to marry, have children, work, or pursue financial independence. Yet amid this increased agency, biology remains one area where our choices can feel unexpectedly limited.

For generations, women believed that motherhood would be available whenever they were ready. But modern lifestyles, environmental exposure, stress, processed foods, hormonal disruptions and urban living have changed the reproductive landscape. While women are most fertile in their twenties and early thirties, fertility begins to decline after 30 and drops more sharply beyond 35, something many women are still not fully aware of.

Egg freezing is often misunderstood as a tool used only by women focused on their careers. In truth, it is far broader. Some women simply don't feel emotionally ready for motherhood. Some haven't met the right partner yet. Others face medical concerns such as cancer, autoimmune disorders or endometriosis that can threaten their fertility. And many are simply unsure, recognising that who we are at 25 or 30 may not reflect who we become later. For many, egg freezing is not about delaying motherhood; it is about keeping a door open, a backup plan, not a first-line plan, and certainly not a guarantee.

I speak with conviction because I made this choice myself. At 32, unmarried and not ready for a child, I decided to check my AMH levels—a simple test

that reflects ovarian reserve. I still remember how startled I felt when I saw the result. My fertility was already declining. It wasn't a glamorous or dramatic moment; it was a quiet, honest realisation. I wasn't sure I wanted to be a mother but I also wasn't sure I didn't. And that grey zone felt far more real than forcing myself into a decision I wasn't ready for.

What I did know was that I didn't want biology making decisions I hadn't yet made for myself. Egg freezing felt practical, grounded and strangely reassuring. Once I understood the science, I acted without hesitation.

Years later, that decision changed everything. I met my partner, and together we chose to build a family. I had my first child at 40 and twins at 44. Without the eggs I froze at 32, when they were healthiest, this may not have been possible. My natural fertility by then had declined significantly, as it does for most women. Preserving my eggs earlier allowed me to embrace motherhood when I was



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